

Cohen Unhappy Over 'Mixups'

Wichita to Start Southpaw Tonight

Successful ninth-inning strategy by Wichita Manager Ben Geraghty paid off with a 10-9 baseball victory for the Braves over the Denver Bears Friday night.

The two teams will play the second game of the series at Lawrence Stadium Saturday at 8 p.m. A double-header is scheduled Sunday.

Claude Raymond, who had set down the Bears in relief in the top of the ninth, singled in shortstop Joe Koppe with the winning run. The hit gave Wichita its first victory of the season against three defeats.

It would have been a perfect place to insert a pinch hitter.

'Pretty Good Hitter'

"But we ran out of pinch hitters. We would have had to use a pitcher anyway. Well, this guy (Raymond) is a pretty good little hitter, so I let him go ahead and bat," Geraghty explained.

Leading up to this run in the final frame were a catcher's error and a bit of luck.

With two outs and two runners on base, Denver catcher John Blanchard dropped a pop foul off the bat of Koppe. Then Koppe singled in Ed Charles and Earl Hersh continued around to score when leftfielder Dick Sanders booted the ball.

That brought Wichita catcher Mike Roarke to the plate. Ro-

AA 'Probables'

Saturday's games and probable pitchers (times CST):

Denver at WICHITA—John Gabler (0-0) vs. Vic Rehm (0-0), 8 p.m.

Minneapolis at Charleston—Dean Stone (0-0) vs. Bob Miller (0-1), 7 p.m.

St. Paul at Louisville—Bob Darnell (0-0) vs. Al Corwin (0-0), 7:30 p.m.

Omaha at Indianapolis—Bill Smith (1-0) vs. Barry Latman (1-0), 7:45 p.m.

Roarke, unknown to the Bears, was playing with an elbow so sore he couldn't swing a bat. Roarke was walked intentionally to fill the bases and set the stage for Raymond's hit.

"We lost the game on errors," Denver Manager Andy Cohen admitted. He also wasn't pleased with his team's mixed signals on a couple of pop-ups.

In the sixth frame, pinch-hitter Mike Krsnich lifted the ball high in front of the plate. Pitcher Ed Donnelly, catcher Blanchard and third baseman Curt Hardaway let the ball fall between them. Blanchard, however, alertly fired to second to force Koppe.

Then, in the sixth with two outs and Braves runners at first and third, pinch-hitter Lee Maye popped another near the pitcher's mound. Hardaway and first baseman Zeka Bella both tried for the easy catch, each got a hand on the ball, and dropped it. This time pitcher John Kucab, who had just entered the game, grabbed the ball before it reached the ground.

Tonight, Geraghty will call on lefthander Vic Rehm to tame the Denver bats, while John Gabler will toil for the Bears.